

1. Operational effectiveness refers to the creation, production, selling, and delivery of a product or service in a particular company. By operating effectively, the company tries to perform these steps better. That means few resources are used as input, but the output is large at scale. Strategic positioning, on the other hand, tries to achieve a competitive advantage by identifying what is unique about the company or competing with other companies by using different methods. If we see operational effectiveness as something most companies could achieve with enough resources, it's easy to swap one for another.
2. Airbnb works more as a service company, as it doesn't own individual households but rather connect hosts with visitors. To raise its competitive advantage, it can lower the cost because most of the time Airbnb users end up being large families who are seeking affordable stays for vacation.
3. The economic factor is shaping Airbnb, since hotels are seen as high cost by many people. There's a huge migration happening where people can easily hop onto planes, and the role of social media is increasing the desire to see many places for which Airbnb comes in handy. Socio-cultural factors are similar, where people are paying more attention to sustainability and affordability, both of which Airbnb seems to offer. However, the increase of political upheavals is making people become more homogenous, and the idea of staying in a stranger's house might seem scary for some.
4. Legal power sometimes limits Airbnb's response ability. As I read through users' comments, it becomes clear that if a customer isn't satisfied with the host, their reach to a customer support team might get delayed. It's especially important since the biographics of a user can be different; a solo female traveler might be in a worse situation than a male visitor. To avoid harm/sexual harassment/stealing, Airbnb needs to make sure there's legality to user trust and that if it's not satisfied, Airbnb can fight for users needs.